

# Communicate Inhibitors to Remediation

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Describe the issues that can inhibit vulnerability remediation.

Learner Objective: *Describe the issues that can inhibit vulnerability remediation.*

Description: In this episode, the learner will explore how to overcome the barriers or obstacles that inhibit a company's ability to remediate vulnerabilities in information systems through communication.

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- Inhibitors to remediation
    - o Memorandum of understanding (MOU)
      - ♣ A statement of intent between the participating organizations to work together and often states goals, objectives, or the purpose for the partnership
      - ♣ Creation of these agreements should include security as well to avoid or include language for vulnerability remediation necessity
    - o Service-level agreement (SLA)
      - ♣ Defines the specific responsibilities of the service provider and sets the customer expectations.
      - ♣ Creation of these agreements should include a potential for service disruption if an incident happens.
    - o Organizational governance
      - ♣ Senior leadership may not be on board with interruptions
      - ♣ The overall process from detection to patching can be long and consume a lot of resources
      - ♣ Compensating controls may be required
      - ♣ While the remediation process may reduce service levels, it has to be conveyed that it will increase security and reduce risks to the company
    - o Degrading functionality
      - ♣ With SLAs in mind, reduced performance or functionality or service quality might put the company a risk of a violation, which can bring penalties.
      - ♣ Vulnerability scanning can consume large amounts of bandwidth
      - ♣ Can interrupt business processes
    - o Legacy system
      - ♣ Legacy systems cannot be patched, present a high degree of risk
      - ♣ Virtually no support
      - ♣ May be required to support business systems as the cost may be too expensive to upgrade or deploy new software
      - ♣ May have to implement compensating controls
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Additional Resources:

NIST - [https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/memorandum\\_of\\_understanding\\_or\\_agreement#:~:text=Definition\(s\)%3A,party%](https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/memorandum_of_understanding_or_agreement#:~:text=Definition(s)%3A,party%3A)

NIST - [https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/service\\_level\\_agreement](https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/service_level_agreement)

